



Pranav Khare <khare.pranav@gmail.com>

Invitation to Review for IEEE Access Access-2024-50424

1 message

IEEE Access <onbehalf@manuscriptcentral.com>

Sun, Jan 19, 2025 at 12:27 PM

Reply-To: ieeeaccess2@ieee.org

To: khare.pranav@gmail.com

19-Jan-2025

Dear Mr. Khare:

The manuscript entitled "Applying the Block-Based Programming Language ALICE for Developing Programming Competencies in University Students" has been submitted to IEEE Access. Since your expertise is relevant to this article, we would be grateful if you would consider reviewing it.

The abstract appears at the end of this letter, along with the names of the authors. Please let me know within 2 days if you will be able to accept my invitation to review. If you agree to review, we ask that you provide your review comments within **7 days** to assist IEEE Access in maintaining its expedited peer review process of 4 to 6 weeks. If you are interested in reviewing but need additional time to complete the review, we can grant a reasonable deadline extension upon request. For additional information on IEEE Access and tips on completing a quality review, please visit our [Reviewer Best Practices guide](#).

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Thank you for your assistance with the peer review of this IEEE Access article.

Sincerely,

Prof. Mehrdad Saif

Editor-in-Chief, IEEE Access
ieeeaccess2@ieee.org

MANUSCRIPT DETAILS

TYPE: Research Article

TITLE: Applying the Block-Based Programming Language ALICE for Developing Programming Competencies in University Students

AUTHORS: MARIUXI, VINUEZA-MORALES; JESENNIA, CARDENAS-COBO; JÉSSICA, CABEZAS-QUINTO; CRISTIAN, VIDAL-SILVA

ABSTRACT: The information society is part of modern life, and algorithmic thinking and programming are relevant to everybody, regardless of educational background. Today's world needs professionals with computing competencies. Higher education programming classes usually use text-based programming languages to develop programming competencies, usually without success for all students. Traditional programming languages consider syntax barriers that complicate their adoption and usefulness for students. Block-based programming languages such as SCRATCH and ALICE permit the development of programming competencies without text coding and syntax restrictions to solve that issue. There are different research works on SCRATCH experiences, but not many experiences on how to use ALICE overall in higher education. This article aims to evaluate the effectiveness of the ALICE programming language in enhancing programming learning outcomes for university students and addressing the limited number of empirical studies of ALICE in higher education contexts. The research involved a literature review to provide a theoretical foundation, followed by an experimental phase that involved two groups: the control group, which followed the traditional programming instruction method with a text-based programming language, and the experimental group, which used the block-based ALICE environment. The experimental group achieved better results with an average score of 80, while the control group scored 65 points on a 100-point scale. The results obtained highlight the effectiveness of the ALICE environment in supporting the programming learning process for first-level Software Engineering university students.

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